GeeksFinder UI/UX Design Guide for Claude Code

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The single source of truth for how GeeksFinder looks, moves and speaks. Claude Code must follow it on every UI task so the product feels designed, not generated.

1. How to use this guide with Claude Code

Export this doc as Markdown, save it as `DESIGN.md` in the repo root, and reference it from `CLAUDE.md` so Claude Code reads it before every UI change.

1. Export → Markdown, save as `/DESIGN.md`. (Export → Word gives you a .docx copy for sharing.)
2. Add this line to `CLAUDE.md`:

```
## UI rules
Before creating or changing any UI, read DESIGN.md and follow it exactly.
Use only the tokens in tailwind.config and app/globals.css. Never invent new
colors, fonts, radii or shadows.
If a design decision is not covered by DESIGN.md, ask before choosing.
```

3. Build the tokens first (section 4), then components (section 6), then pages (section 7). Never build a page before its components exist.
4. After every UI task, Claude Code runs the QA checklist (section 10) and takes a screenshot at 375 px and 1440 px to self-review.

Rules Claude Code must follow

- Tokens are law: no raw hex values, pixel font sizes or ad-hoc shadows in components.
- Real content only: use the sample jobs, names and copy in this guide, never lorem ipsum.
- One signature moment per page; everything else stays quiet (section 3).
- Every interactive element has hover, focus-visible, active, disabled and loading states.
- Mobile first: design at 375 px, then scale up.

2. Brand and positioning

GeeksFinder is a calm, competent senior who sends you the right jobs every morning and helps you apply properly; the design must feel trustworthy enough that a student sets up UPI Autopay on day one.

Name and wordmark

- Brand name: **GeeksFinder**, always one word with capital G and F. Never "Geeks Finder", "GF" or "geeksfinder" in copy.
- Wordmark: "GeeksFinder" set in Schibsted Grotesk 700 in `ink`, tracking -0.02em, with a short `highlight` stroke under "Finder" drawn like a highlighter mark. No mascot, no gradient.
- Favicon / app icon: "G" in white on `action`, 8 px radius at 32 px.
- Telegram bot: @GeeksFinderBot (check availability); channel: GeeksFinder Jobs.

Audience

Final-year students and fresh graduates in India, mostly on Android phones, often on mid-range devices and 4G. They live in Telegram and WhatsApp, distrust anything that looks like a scam job portal, and are price-sensitive but will pay small amounts for clear value.

Core promise

Wake up to jobs that fit your resume, and apply to each one with a resume that fits the job.

Message hierarchy

1. Matched jobs every morning on Telegram (the habit)
2. One-click resume tailoring (the wow moment)
3. HR email in one click (the edge over other applicants)
4. ₹10 per 15 days, cancel from your UPI app (the low-risk close)

Brand personality

We are	We are not
Specific: "14 new matches for React developer"	Hype: "Unlock your dream career!"

We are	We are not
Calm and competent	Loud, urgent, countdown timers
Honest about what we do	Promising guaranteed jobs or placements
Student-friendly, plain English	Corporate HR jargon

Signature visual idea: the highlighter

Students highlight what matters in their notes. Our signature is a highlighter-yellow mark that shows where a resume meets a job: matched skills are highlighted on job cards, on the resume diff and in the hero animation. It is the one memorable element; everything else stays quiet.

Conversion goals

Page	Primary action	Secondary action
Landing	Upload your resume	See a sample alert
Onboarding	Connect Telegram	Choose alert time
Dashboard	Tailor resume for a job	Email HR
Pricing / upgrade	Start 7-day free trial (autopay)	Stay on free plan

3. Anti vibe-coded rules

A site feels AI-generated when it uses defaults nobody chose; every rule below replaces a default with a decision specific to this product.

Never do this	Do this instead
Purple/indigo gradient hero, blurred colour blobs	Plain white page; the hero is a real product moment (alert + highlighted match)
Every section fades and slides up on scroll	One orchestrated hero animation; elsewhere motion only responds to user actions

Never do this	Do this instead
Hover lift + shadow on every card	Hover changes only what is clickable: border colour or one underline
Identical rounded cards with the same soft grey shadow	Mix of surfaces: flat rows, one framed panel, real UI screenshots
One italic or coloured word in each headline	Whole headline in one style; the highlighter mark is used only on real matched skills
ALL-CAPS tracked eyebrow above every heading	Headings stand alone; labels only when they add information
01 / 02 / 03 markers on non-sequential content	Numbers only for the real 3-step flow (upload, match, apply)
"→" after every button and link	Clear verb labels: "Upload your resume", "See a sample alert"
Glassmorphism, neon glows, grain overlays	Solid surfaces, 1 px borders, crisp type
Emoji as icons, mixed icon sets	One icon set (Lucide), 1.5 px stroke, 20 px default
Fake testimonials, fake logos, "10,000+ users"	Only real numbers; until then, show a real sample alert and a real resume before/after
Lorem ipsum and "John Doe"	Real Indian sample data: "Frontend Developer Intern · Zepto · Bengaluru"
Default shadcn look with no changes	shadcn primitives restyled with our tokens
Centre-aligned everything	Left-aligned text on a 12-column grid; centre only short CTAs
Dark mode as the default "techy" look	Light by default; dark mode added later as a full token set

The quality bar

Before shipping any screen, ask: would a senior designer at a funded Indian startup (Razorpay, CRED, Zerodha level of polish) ship this? If any element exists only because it "looks modern", remove it.

4. Design tokens

Cool white paper, navy ink, one highlighter yellow and one action blue; Schibsted Grotesk for the interface and Source Serif 4 only for resume content.

Colour

Token	Hex	Use
`paper`	#FFFFFF	Page background
`paper-2`	#F5F7FA	Section bands, input backgrounds
`line`	#E3E7ED	Borders, dividers
`ink`	#14213D	Headings, primary text
`ink-2`	#4A5568	Body text
`ink-3`	#7A8494	Captions, placeholders (large text only)
`action`	#2457D6	Primary buttons, links, focus ring
`action-dark`	#1A44AE	Button hover / pressed
`highlight`	#FFE45C	Matched-skill highlighter (signature)
`success`	#16794C	Applied, payment success
`warning`	#B45309	Payment pending, low quota
`danger`	#C0362C	Errors, failed payment

Contrast rules: text on `highlight` is always `ink`; `ink-2` and `action` pass WCAG AA on white. Never place text on a gradient.

Typography

Role	Font	Size / line height	Weight
Display (hero only)	Schibsted Grotesk	56/60 desktop, 38/42 mobile, tracking -0.02em	700
H1	Schibsted Grotesk	40/46, mobile 30/36	700

Role	Font	Size / line height	Weight
H2	Schibsted Grotesk	28/34, mobile 24/30	600
H3	Schibsted Grotesk	20/28	600
Body	Schibsted Grotesk	16/26	400
Small	Schibsted Grotesk	14/20	400–500
Resume preview text	Source Serif 4	14/22	400 / 600
Numbers (scores, prices)	Schibsted Grotesk, tabular figures	as context	600

Both fonts are free on Google Fonts; load with `next/font`. Sentence case everywhere. Max line length 70 characters.

Spacing, radius, elevation

Token	Value
Spacing scale	4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 96, 128 px
Section padding	96 px desktop, 64 px mobile
Radius: inputs, buttons	10 px
Radius: panels, sheets	16 px
Radius: chips, highlighter	4 px (highlighter looks hand-drawn, not a pill)
Elevation 0	1 px `line` border, no shadow (default)
Elevation 1	0 1px 2px rgba(20,33,61,.06), 0 8px 24px rgba(20,33,61,.08): only for floating UI (menus, toasts, the hero phone)

Layout grid

- 12 columns, 1200 px max content width, 24 px gutters; 4 columns with 16 px gutters on mobile.

- Landing text is left-aligned; product visuals sit on the right on desktop, below on mobile.
- Dashboard: 240 px left sidebar on desktop, bottom tab bar on mobile.

5. Motion system

The site is animated in one place on purpose: the hero tells the product story in about 4 seconds, and everywhere else motion only confirms what the user just did.

Timing and easing tokens

Token	Duration	Easing	Use
`instant`	100 ms	ease-out	Button press, checkbox
`quick`	180 ms	cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)	Hover colour, tooltips, tab switch
`standard`	280 ms	cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)	Panels, sheets, accordions
`emphasis`	450 ms	cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)	Hero steps, success states
`spring`	stiffness 400, damping 32	Framer Motion spring	Kanban drag, toasts

Never exceed 500 ms for UI responses. Animate only `transform` and `opacity` (plus `clip-path` for the highlighter) so it stays 60 fps on mid-range Android.

The hero sequence (the signature moment)

Runs once on load, total ~4 s, then rests on its final frame:

1. 0.0 s: A job description card is visible with plain text.
2. 0.4 s: The highlighter sweeps left-to-right across "React", "REST APIs" and "Git" (clip-path reveal, 450 ms each, 120 ms stagger).
3. 1.8 s: The match score counts up from 0 to 87 (tabular figures, 600 ms).
4. 2.6 s: A Telegram-style alert slides up into a phone frame beside it (spring), showing "3 new matches for you".

5. 3.4 s: The "Tailor resume" button in the alert gets a single soft pulse of the focus ring, then stops.

A "Replay" text button sits under the visual. No looping.

Motion that responds to actions

Action	Feedback
Resume upload	Progress bar, then detected skills appear one by one as highlighted chips (60 ms stagger)
Tailor resume	Diff view: removed lines fade to 40% with strikethrough, new lines highlight in yellow then settle to white over 1.2 s
Save / apply on a job	Icon morphs to a check (180 ms); card moves to the tracker column with a shared-layout animation
Telegram connected	Status chip swaps from grey to green with a check; no confetti
Payment success	Checkmark draws in (450 ms), next debit date appears below
Errors	Field border turns `danger` and message appears; one 4 px horizontal shake only for wrong OTP

Scroll behaviour

- No scroll-triggered fade-ins on landing sections.
- Allowed: the "How it works" sticky section, where the product visual on the right swaps between 3 steps as the text scrolls (crossfade, `standard`).
- No scroll-jacking, no parallax, no smooth-scroll libraries.

Reduced motion

When `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce` is set, show the final frame of every animation instantly, keep opacity crossfades under 150 ms, and disable the hero sequence and pulse.

6. Component specs

Build these nine components first; every page is assembled only from them.

Button

Variant	Style	Use
Primary	`action` fill, white text, 44 px height (48 on mobile), 10 px radius	One per view
Secondary	White fill, 1 px `line` border, `ink` text	Supporting actions
Text	`action` text, underline on hover	Inline and tertiary
Danger	`danger` text, border on hover	Cancel subscription, delete

States: hover = `action-dark`; focus-visible = 2 px `action` ring with 2 px offset; loading = spinner replaces label, width stays fixed; disabled = 40% opacity, no pointer.

Job card

A flat row on desktop (not a floating card), stacked on mobile:

- Left: company initial in a 40 px square tile (`paper-2`), title (H3), company · city · posted time in `ink-3`.
- Middle: up to 4 skill chips; skills the student has get the `highlight` background.
- Right: match score, Save icon button, primary "Tailor resume" and secondary "Email HR".
- Badges only for real facts: "Fresher-friendly", "Remote", "Internship".

Sample data: Frontend Developer Intern · Zepto · Bengaluru · 2 h ago · React, TypeScript, Git, REST APIs · 87% match.

Match score

A number, not a fake progress ring: "87% match" in 600 weight with tabular figures. Colour: ⩾ 80 `success`, 60–79 `ink`, below 60 not shown. Tooltip lists the reasons: "4 of 5 skills · Fresher role · Bengaluru".

Highlighter mark

A `highlight` background behind text, 4 px radius, slight -1deg skew on a pseudo-element so it looks hand-drawn, 2 px horizontal padding. Used only on matched skills and newly tailored resume lines.

Telegram alert preview

A realistic phone frame (no brand logos of Telegram beyond a neutral chat UI) showing the bot's digest: header "Good morning, Priya", 3 job rows with match %, and inline buttons "Tailor resume" and "Open job". Used in the hero and onboarding.

Resume diff

Two columns on desktop (Before / Tailored), single column with toggle on mobile. Resume text in Source Serif 4 on a white A4-ratio sheet with 1 px border. Changed lines: old line struck through in `ink-3`, new line with highlighter. Buttons: "Accept all", per-line "Undo", "Download PDF".

Pricing block

Two plans side by side, Free and Pro, with Pro outlined by a 2 px `action` border (not a glowing badge). Price set large: "₹10" with "every 15 days" beside it. Under the button: "7-day free trial · Autopay via UPI · Cancel anytime from your UPI app".

Application tracker

Kanban with 5 columns: Saved, Applied, Interview, Offer, Rejected. Columns are `paper-2` bands; items are compact rows (title, company, date). Drag uses the `spring` token; on mobile, use a segmented control instead of drag.

Toasts and empty states

- Toast: bottom-centre on mobile, bottom-right on desktop, auto-dismiss in 4 s, verb-matched ("Resume tailored", "Email draft ready").
- Empty state: one sentence of direction plus one button, e.g. "No matches yet. Add 3 more skills to widen your results." + "Edit skills".

7. Page blueprints

The landing page has nine blocks and one job: get the resume uploaded; the app pages are built to make the morning alert a daily habit.

Landing page, top to bottom

1. **Navbar** (64 px, white, 1 px bottom border after scroll): GeeksFinder wordmark left; "How it works", "Pricing", "Blog", "FAQ"; "Log in" text button; primary "Upload your resume". Mobile: wordmark + primary button + menu icon.
2. **Hero** (left text, right animated visual from section 5):
   - Headline: "Wake up to jobs that fit your resume."
   - Subhead: "Every morning, get fresher jobs matched to your skills on Telegram. Tailor your resume and email HR in one click."
   - Primary: "Upload your resume" · Secondary: "See a sample alert"
   - Under buttons, `ink-3` small: "Free to start. No card needed."
3. **How it works** (sticky scroll, a real 3-step sequence, so numbers are allowed):
   - Upload your resume: "We read your skills, projects and education in seconds."
   - Get matched jobs: "New jobs from LinkedIn, company career pages and job boards, scored against your skills."
   - Apply properly: "Tailor your resume to each job and send HR a personal email."
4. **Resume before/after**: the resume diff component with a real sample, headline "Same you. Better fit for every job." Note under it: "We only rephrase what's already true. We never add skills you don't have."
5. **Alerts your way**: a compact row showing daily / weekly / monthly and Telegram / email toggles as real controls (interactive demo, no signup needed).
6. **Pricing**: the pricing block, headline "Less than a cup of chai every two weeks."
7. **FAQ** (accordion, 6 items): Is it really ₹10? How does autopay work? How do I cancel? Where do jobs come from? Is my resume data safe? Do you apply for me?
8. **Final CTA band** (`paper-2`): "Your next interview could start with tomorrow's alert." + "Upload your resume".
9. **Footer**: Privacy, Terms, Refund policy, Contact, Telegram channel link.

Onboarding (4 steps, progress bar at top)

1. Upload resume → animated skill detection → edit skills.

2. Preferences: roles, cities (+ Remote), job type.
3. Alerts: frequency, time (default 7:30 AM), channel; "Connect Telegram" opens the bot deep link and the page waits with a live status chip.
4. Done: first 5 matches shown immediately, so value arrives before any payment ask.

Dashboard

- Sidebar (desktop) / bottom tabs (mobile): Matches, Tracker, Resumes, Alerts, Billing.
- Matches: filter bar (role, city, remote, fresher), list of job rows sorted by match score, "New today" divider.
- Daily usage strip for free users: "1 of 1 tailored resume used · Upgrade for 10 per cycle" (quiet, never a blocking modal).

Billing

- Current plan, next debit date and amount in large type: "Next debit ₹10 on 29 Oct".
- Payment history table.
- "How to cancel": plain steps for cancelling the mandate in the UPI app, plus a cancel button. Never hide cancellation; it builds the trust that gets people to subscribe.

Blog (AI news articles)

The blog reads like a quiet career newsletter, not a content farm.

- **Index:** one featured article (headline, 2-line summary, date) above a simple list of rows: title, one-line summary, topic, date. No thumbnail grid of stock photos; use a plain topic tag instead.
- **Article page:** 680 px reading column, Source Serif 4 body at 19/32 for long reading, headings in Schibsted Grotesk. Byline: "GeeksFinder Desk, reviewed by <name>" and the date.
- **"What this means for freshers"** box: `paper-2` band with a left `highlight` bar, set apart from the news.
- **Matching jobs block:** 3 live job rows (job card component) under the article with "See all matches" leading to signup.
- **Sources:** numbered list at the end, each linking out.
- **Admin review queue** (internal): table of drafts with overlap score, fact-check status, and Approve / Edit / Reject buttons.

8. Copywriting rules

Write like a helpful senior talking to a junior: short, specific, honest, in plain Indian English.

- Sentence case for every heading, button and label.
- Buttons say exactly what happens: "Upload your resume", "Tailor resume", "Email HR", "Start free trial". The toast after uses the same verb: "Resume tailored".
- Use numbers instead of adjectives: "14 new matches" beats "tons of jobs".
- Never promise outcomes we can't control: no "guaranteed job", "100% placement", "get hired fast".
- Money copy is always explicit: amount, frequency, how to cancel.
- Errors say what happened and how to fix it, without apology: "This PDF has no readable text. Upload a text-based PDF, not a scanned image."
- Empty states give direction: one sentence and one button.
- No exclamation marks except in the final success state after payment.
- Names by what users understand: "Alerts", not "Notification preferences"; "Email HR", not "Outreach".

Word list

Use	Avoid
Matches	Opportunities, leads
Tailor resume	Optimise with AI, supercharge
Email HR	Outreach, cold mail
Cancel anytime from your UPI app	Hassle-free, no strings attached
Fresher-friendly	Entry-level talent

9. Tech stack, accessibility and performance

Next.js + Tailwind + restyled shadcn/ui + Framer Motion, built to load fast on a mid-range Android phone on 4G.

Frontend stack

Need	Choice	Rule
Framework	Next.js (App Router)	Server components by default; client only where interactive
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Tokens defined in `tailwind.config` and CSS variables in `globals.css`
Components	shadcn/ui	Restyle every primitive with our tokens before use
Animation	Framer Motion	Import `LazyMotion` + `domAnimation` to keep bundle small
Icons	lucide-react	1.5 px stroke, 20 px default
Fonts	`next/font/google`: Schibsted Grotesk, Source Serif 4	`display: swap`, subset latin
Forms	react-hook-form + zod	Inline validation on blur

Accessibility (WCAG 2.2 AA)

- All text meets 4.5:1 contrast (3:1 for 24 px+).
- Visible focus ring on every interactive element; never `outline: none` without a replacement.
- Tap targets at least 44 × 44 px.
- Highlighter is never the only signal: matched skills also get a check icon and screen-reader text "matched".
- Forms: real `<label>`s, errors linked with `aria-describedby`.
- Animations respect `prefers-reduced-motion` (section 5).

Performance budget

Metric	Target
Largest Contentful Paint (4G, mid-range Android)	< 2.5 s

Metric	Target
Interaction to Next Paint	< 200 ms
Cumulative Layout Shift	< 0.1
Landing page JS (gzipped)	< 170 KB
Hero visual	Built in HTML/CSS/SVG, no video, no Lottie
Images	`next/image`, AVIF/WebP, explicit width and height

10. QA checklist and Claude Code prompts

A screen is done only when every box below is ticked; the prompts after it are pasted into Claude Code in order.

Definition of done (every screen)

- [ ] Uses only tokens; no raw hex, px font sizes or new shadows
- [ ] Checked at 375 px, 768 px and 1440 px via screenshots
- [ ] No rule from section 3 is broken
- [ ] Hover, focus-visible, active, disabled, loading and error states exist
- [ ] Empty state written and designed
- [ ] Reduced-motion version checked
- [ ] Keyboard-only navigation works; focus order is logical
- [ ] Lighthouse: Performance ≥ 90 mobile, Accessibility = 100
- [ ] All copy follows section 8; no lorem ipsum

Prompts for Claude Code (paste in order)

1. Tokens:

```
Read DESIGN.md. Set up the design tokens from section 4 in tailwind.config.ts and app/globals.css as CSS variables. Load Schibsted Grotesk and Source Serif 4 with next/font. Create /app/styleguide showing every colour, type style, spacing step and radius. Do not build any page yet.
```

2. Components:

```
Read DESIGN.md sections 3, 5 and 6. Build Button, JobCard, MatchScore,
Highlighter, TelegramAlertPreview, ResumeDiff, PricingBlock, Tracker and
Toast in /components/ui using shadcn primitives restyled with our tokens. Add
every state. Show them all on /styleguide with the sample data from the
guide. Screenshot at 375 and 1440 px and fix anything that breaks section 3.
```

3. Hero animation:

```
Read DESIGN.md section 5, "The hero sequence". Build the hero visual with
Framer Motion (LazyMotion), animating only transform, opacity and clip-path.
Add a Replay button and a reduced-motion fallback that shows the final frame.
Keep it under 30 KB of JS.
```

4. Landing page:

```
Read DESIGN.md section 7. Build the landing page using only components from
/components/ui and the exact copy in the guide. No scroll fade-ins except the
sticky How it works section. Run the section 10 checklist and report results.
```

5. App pages:

```
Read DESIGN.md section 7. Build onboarding, dashboard (Matches, Tracker,
Resumes, Alerts) and Billing with mock data. Mobile uses bottom tabs. Run the
section 10 checklist.
```

6. Design review (run after every big change):

```
Act as a senior product designer. Review the current UI against DESIGN.md.
List every place that looks generic or AI-generated, breaks a token or rule,
or has weak hierarchy. Fix them, then screenshot again.
```